

Newer cars mean that when we wreck them we make the repairs rather than simply junk the car. Children bring joy, but they bring headaches as well.

One way to live on \$743 a month is to rediscover how you lived as a student. Students avoid expensive restaurants. They ride to parties together and take turns driving. They save money on food by clipping coupons, buying in discount supermarkets, and using meat tenderizer. They travel on charter flights, stay in hotel rooms with bathrooms down the hall, and use buses and their feet rather than taxis and rental cars. They wear cotton denims and simple shirts. Most of their clothing budget goes to buy one or two pairs of comfortable walking shoes.

Most important, students—and bare-bones retirees—share living space with others. Sharing living space again after all these years will be a sacrifice. You value your privacy. But sacrifice is a part of bare-bones retirement in the United States. And if you use your imagination, you should be able to come up with a creative, low-cost way to share living space that fits your needs.

Last July and August, when I took my sax lessons at the Berklee College of Music in Boston, Vicki and I rented a furnished, two-bedroom apartment in Boston for \$400 a month. That's a reasonable amount when you're living on \$50 a day. But when you're on a bare-bones budget you've got to find something cheaper. One of the Berklee faculty members I met had found it. He shared a five-bedroom house with four other people.

I asked him how he liked it.

"I'm a big guy," he said. "I need large, airy spaces and I like our big living room. My housemates are musicians. The house sits on a big lot, so we can practice our instruments without bothering the neighbors. I like having someone to share the housework. Yet I have privacy—my own room and furniture and my own telephone. The neighborhood's coming up and the house is in good shape. I could never handle the